

Digital Organizing Playbook

Run campaigns online without handing your data to surveillance capitalism.

Principle 1 — Own Your List

- Social media followers are not your base. The platform can remove your account at any time.
- Build an email list from day one — the only digital asset you truly own.
- Every campaign action should include an email capture.
- Target: 1,000 emails = meaningful local list. 10,000 = significant campaign infrastructure.

Principle 2 — Peer-to-Peer Texting

- P2P texting gets 90%+ open rates vs 20% for email.
- Tools: ThruText, Spoke (open source), or Hustle.
- Use for: event reminders, rapid response, direct action mobilization.
- Consent required: only text people who have explicitly opted in.

Principle 3 — Ethical Social Media Strategy

Content Pillar 1	STORIES — human narratives of people affected by the injustice you fight.
Content Pillar 2	EVIDENCE — documents, data, records that prove your claims.
Content Pillar 3	ACTION — specific things followers can do right now.
Content Pillar 4	WIN STORIES — celebrate victories publicly and specifically.
Cadence	3–5 posts/week on primary platform. Quality over quantity.
Avoid	Content that exploits trauma. Posting faces without consent. Vague calls to action.

Principle 4 — Community-Owned Platforms

- Internal comms: Signal groups (NOT Facebook or WhatsApp).
- Docs: CryptPad or Nextcloud (self-hosted).
- Website: Ghost (self-hosted) or WordPress — platforms you control.
- Events: Mobilize.us or direct email/Signal — avoid Facebook Events for strategy.

Digital Campaign Launch Checklist

[] Email list started	[] Primary social media account secured
[] Signal group for core team created	[] Action landing page built
[] Email auto-responder set up	[] P2P texting platform selected
[] Analytics tracking installed	[] Content calendar drafted (4 weeks)

☐ Crisis comms protocol established	☐ 2FA enabled on all accounts
☐ Data retention policy documented	☐ Privacy policy on website
<i>TIP: Biggest mistake: confusing likes with power. Power is built through relationships and commitment — digital tools amplify that, they do not replace it.</i>	